AHSAN IFTIKHAR

Senior Software Engineer · Full-Stack · React · React Native · AI
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SUMMARY

Senior engineer with 5 years shipping production fintech and AI systems. Draws a deliberate line between deterministic, auditable computation and where LLM judgment actually adds value — the trade-order service behind live Charles Schwab execution has no model in it anywhere, while 3 of 7 modules in a sales intelligence suite were built LLM-free by design. At a 25-person U.S. wealth-management startup, owns the React web platform and React Native app (1,000+ active users) along with the backend services, LLM pipelines, and GCP infrastructure behind them.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer Dec 2024 – Present
Lumida Wealth — New Jersey, USA (Remote) · ~25-person wealth-management startup, 7-person engineering team

- Own the React front-end for Lumida AI, the in-house equities-research platform the CIO team uses to drive live U.S. market investment decisions — factor analysis, earnings-call transcripts, backtesting, and portfolio management among 8 modules — backed by a Flask/Firestore backend.
- Built the LLM layer across that platform: auto-summarization of financial news and earnings transcripts, structured market-sentiment extraction, and pipelines ingesting ~1,000 posts/day from ~300 curated stock-market X (Twitter) accounts into the CIO research workflow. Also shipped conversational Slack and Telegram agents serving a 500+ member investor community and the internal CIO team.
- Lead mobile engineer on Lumida Invest, a React Native stocks and crypto app in beta with 1,000+ active users — leading 3 engineers and owning iOS and Android releases, brokerage account linking, push notifications, and deep linking. Resolved a critical Android blocker by moving API calls, store dispatches, and heavy computation off the JS thread with React Native Worklets, eliminating dropped frames during live price updates on mid-tier devices.
- Built and own Trade Sheet, the internal service the desk uses to turn analyst portfolio allocations into executable per-account orders for Charles Schwab — cutting trade-sheet preparation from ~2 hours of manual spreadsheet work to ~5 seconds, with live price validation and firm trading restrictions enforced before any order reaches the brokerage.
- Delivered a 7-module sales intelligence suite over HubSpot to the revenue team, pairing deterministic pipeline and forecasting analytics with an LLM layer for deal scoring, lost-deal review, and automated call coaching — with rule-based overrides keeping high-stakes verdicts out of the model's hands. Now the daily working surface for the team's ~$50M pipeline.
- Set front-end code standards and led code review across a 4-person team, drove the migration of legacy React class components to functional components with hooks, and mentor the 3 engineers on the mobile team through release and deployment ownership.
- Replaced manual SSH-per-push deployment with GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines across 5–7 production GCP projects, removing hand-run deploy steps from a multiple-times-daily release cycle; manage VM provisioning, backend service operation, Nginx configuration, and subdomain setup.
- Cut time-to-interactive on charting and long-table views from ~1.8s to ~1.2s via memoization and virtualized rendering.

Software Engineer Jul 2022 – Nov 2024
Paysys Labs — Karachi, Pakistan

- Senior front-end engineer across three banking products, owning each from inception: National Bank of Pakistan's digital account-opening portal, National Savings' onboarding platform, and National Savings Digital — and mentored 2 interns through their first production work.
- Developed Jasper reports (complex SQL / PL-SQL) consumed by 300+ National Savings branches nationwide for transaction and KYC reporting; optimized report queries and rebuilt the reporting interface for faster loads and a modernized design.
- Built ETL pipelines for bulk data migration across core-banking tables, improving downstream query performance for reporting workloads.
- Developed backend services with Node.js, Express, NestJS, and .NET, and ran endpoint load and stress testing with JMeter to resolve performance bottlenecks before release.

Software Engineer Jan 2022 – Jun 2022
Teresol — Karachi, Pakistan

- Built front-end features in Vue.js for a core banking overhaul — accounts, transactions, loans, CRM, teller/cash management, KYC — implementing JWT authentication/authorization and XState-based middleware for complex application state on a Quarkus/SQL backend.

Associate Software Engineer Aug 2021 – Dec 2021
Medicon — Karachi, Pakistan

- Built React.js user-interface components for responsive web applications, translating cross-functional product requirements into shipped front-end features and optimizing rendering performance.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Trade Sheet — Automated Trade Order Preparation — Python, Flask, Firestore, GCS, WebSockets, Google Sheets API, pandas

- Flask REST API converting analyst percentage allocations into exact per-account share quantities across four order types (buy, sell, short, cover), generating the sheets used to execute orders at Charles Schwab.

- Real-time price validation over a WebSocket market-data feed rejects orders whose spreadsheet prices deviate more than 7% from live prices, preventing execution on stale data; a Firestore-backed constraint engine blocks trades violating firm ticker/account restrictions before they reach the brokerage.
- Google Sheets → GCS/Parquet pipeline powers position-aware validation. No LLM anywhere in the path — every number is reproducible and auditable.

Sales Intelligence Platform — HubSpot CRM & AI Automation Suite — Python, Flask, OpenAI o4-mini, HubSpot API, Gong, GCP

- Architected a two-agent scoring pipeline — one agent extracts intent, urgency, and blockers from unstructured deal history; a second, fully deterministic agent combines those signals with rule-based scores into a 5-tier priority stack — with hard rule overrides and strict JSON-schema validation so the model never has final say on high-stakes verdicts.
- Built 7 sales-ops modules across 2 pipelines and 16 stages, including lost-deal review with a consent veto blocking re-engagement for opted-out contacts, and a Gong-to-HubSpot integration scoring calls against a 100-point coaching rubric with RAG-grounded product references.
- Built 3 of the 7 modules deliberately LLM-free — rep scorecards, revenue forecasting, and SDR lead routing — where the business needed reproducible, auditable numbers.

Lumida Invest — React Native Fintech App (iOS & Android) — React Native 0.81, Redux Toolkit, WebSockets, SSE, Firebase, SnapTrade

- Integrated the SnapTrade SDK for external brokerage account linking (connect/disconnect flows, multi-account portfolio views) and built the Portfolio module end-to-end — holdings, sorting, tax-loss-harvesting views, and live price/returns wired to WebSocket data.
- Designed the deep-linking architecture (custom scheme, iOS Universal Links, Android App Links, /dl/ gateway) and the notification system end-to-end, routing 6+ notification types with Notifee badge sync and guest-device fallback. Shipped a conversational AI assistant with voice input and SSE-streamed responses.

Lumida Second Opinion — Financial Diagnostic & Lead-Gen Platform — React 19, Vite, Flask, REST, GCP, Stripe

- Replaced a single-file HTML prototype with a server-authoritative React 19 + Vite SPA: all scoring and rules logic stays in the Flask backend with zero business logic duplicated client-side, and a channel-aware evaluation contract lets one engine safely serve both the gated internal advisor tool and the unauthenticated public flow.
- Built a live findings rail with debounced, abort-superseded requests, plus GitHub Actions CI/CD to a GCP VM and a feature-flagged Stripe paywall. secondopinion.lumida.com

ResumeGrade — AI Resume Feedback App (Personal Project) — Next.js, FastAPI, Groq / Cerebras / OpenRouter

- Free AI web app returning structured, actionable resume feedback. Shipped solo: Next.js/Vercel front-end, FastAPI backend, and full SEO.
- Multi-provider LLM waterfall (Groq → Cerebras → OpenRouter) for reliability and cost control, with spaCy-based PII redaction stripping personal data before any LLM call. resumegrade.vercel.app

Earlier Banking Platforms — NBP & National Savings — React, React Query, Node.js, Snyk

- Led front-end development from inception on National Bank of Pakistan's digital account-opening portal (React Query caching, Snyk hardening) and National Savings' onboarding platform, where I also built the Node.js backend. newaccount.nbp.com.pk/landing-page | account.nationalsavings.digital

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, C#, SQL (PL/SQL)

Frontend: React, Next.js, Vite, React Query, XState, Material UI, HTML, CSS

Mobile: React Native (iOS & Android), Push Notifications, Deep Linking, Reanimated / Worklets

Backend: Node.js, Express.js, NestJS, Flask, FastAPI, .NET, REST APIs, WebSockets, Socket.IO, JWT, Stripe

AI & Automation: OpenAI / LLM integration, multi-agent pipelines, prompt engineering, structured output & schema validation, RAG, Slack/Telegram/X bots

Databases & Data: Oracle SQL, Firestore, pandas, Parquet, ETL, Jasper Reports

Cloud & DevOps: Google Cloud (Compute Engine), Nginx, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Git, JMeter

Integrations: HubSpot CRM API, Gong, SnapTrade, Google Sheets API, Stripe

EDUCATION

BS, Computer Science — FAST – NUCES, Karachi, Pakistan — Aug 2018 – Jun 2022